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Problem framing and prioritisation

YouTube

Project Brief:

- Imagine you're a PM at Youtube Shorts tasked with increasing social interaction on shortform videos posted by creators.
    - Engagement = Like/Share/Comment on videos
- Interview ~20 youtube users across different age groups :
    - Conduct secondary research online
    - Build a quick questionnaire
    - Conduct direct interviews (use minor incentives if needed)
    - Analyse interview notes
- Your goal is to turn your research & understanding about the space to:
    - Figure the top 6 most effective ways to increase engagement across Youtube shorts – force yourself to think of 3 low-effort ideas and 3 high-effort but massive impact ideas.
    - Make sure to justify each idea with a clear rationale coming from user research and/or product strategy
- Prioritize the ideas using the **RICE framework** – use the same template as used for the live exercise.

Performed by:

Arpit Sahay

Shrihari Upadhyaya





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Problem Statement 🚩

Increasing social interactions and engagements on short-form videos posted by creators on YouTube in terms of:



Research Goals 🎯

- Study user behavior across different age groups
- Find out key factors affecting user engagements
- Identify effective ways to tackle the issues with low and high effort solutions

Research Methodology 🔭

- Direct Interview
- Secondary research (Internet)

YouTube Shorts



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User Research

Personal Interview

Internet Research

Questionnaire

- How often do you use YouTube Shorts?
- How is your experience using YouTube Shorts compared to other short-form content sharing platforms
- What do you feel about your recommendation algorithm
- How often do you engage with the content (leave a like, comment or share the video)
- As a viewer have you experienced any issues?

Interview Insights 💬

“ Short to short transition is not smooth and UI looks very cluttered.

Doctor, 37, Bengaluru





Until this interview I didn’t even knew the YouTube mobile app has these many features for us creators! ”

Creator, 27, Gurugram

“ The shorts are not relevant to my taste sometimes.

Student, 13, Bengaluru





I open YouTube shorts after I get bored watching reels ”

Student, 21, Bihar

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User Research

Personal Interview — Internet Research



Vinutha Bhat

Budding Lawyer, Bengaluru

Stats:

Age: 23

Usage: ~1.5 Hours

Interests: Podcasts

“Sometimes I can not see the labels which written on the shorts since the UI is very cluttered”

“Shorts will stop immediately sometimes even though the network is good”

Rahul Jain



Business Man, Bengaluru

Stats:

Age: 31

Usage: 2-3 Hours

Interests: Random videos



Arslaan Sharique

Content Creator, Patna

Stats:

Age: 22

Usage: 3-4 Hours

Interests: Gaming

As a creator, I want some tools from where I can trim and instantly post a YT Short of my long-form videos in the YouTube Studio itself.

“I receive many unwanted shorts which do not suits my occupation and personality”

Arjun Pandith

Pandit, Bengaluru



Stats:

Age: 33

Usage: 30-45 Min

Interests: Pravachan, Astrology

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User Research

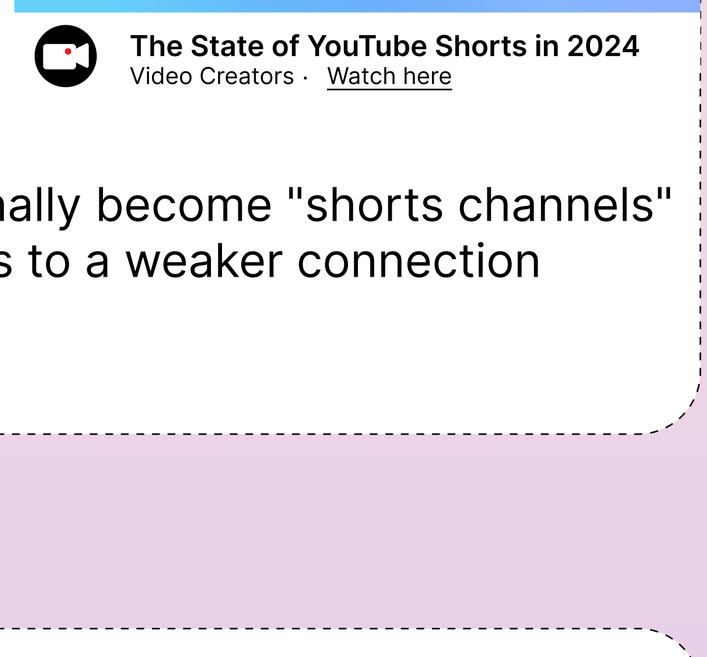
Personal Interview

Internet Research

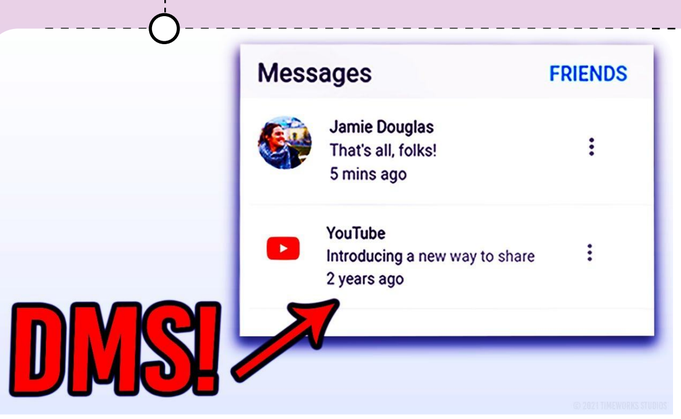
This podcast primarily discussed the current state and future predictions for YouTube Shorts, exploring its impact on creators, viewers, and content strategies for 2024.

Host discussed that most of the time shorts are highly irrelevant, so much so that the viewer is just watching for the sake of it until he/she falls asleep

They also discussed how some creators unintentionally become "shorts channels" when their goal was long-form content. Which leads to a weaker connection between shorts viewership and long-form video.



The State of YouTube Shorts in 2024
Video Creators · Watch here



What happened to YouTube DMs?
Timeworks · Watch here

The creator talks about a feature of YouTube Messages which was introduced in 2017 where users could share youtube videos with friends like a social media platform.

The feature was removed by YouTube in 2019 stating that they are focusing on features like stories, posts and other features.

The only probable reason stated by the creator was less engagements on messages since the users were not informed about this new feature, it was enjoyed by niche users of YouTube however, totally missed by majority of users

Key Insights

- Users are mostly not aware of features being rolled out by YouTube which is a major loss of user engagements
- The algorithm of YouTube shorts is found to be underwhelming when compared to other platforms like Instagram Reels
- Creators feels a lack of tools and features for creating short form content.

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Solutions 💡

Low-Effort Solutions

- Polishing YT Shorts UI
- Set up a way to convey new features and updates with the user
- Add option to choose interested or not interested button for users

High-Effort Solutions

- Reworking on Algorithm
- Integrate YT Shorts editing suite on YT Studio
- Bring back YouTube DMs which can drastically increase shares while still being on the platform

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RICE FRAMEWORK

Priority	Project	Reach	Impact	Confidence	Effort	Score
🔥🔥🔥...	Reworking on Algorithm	10M	2.5	80%	12	1.67
🔥🔥🔥...	Integrate YT Shorts editing suite on YT Studio	8M	2.0	90%	10	1.44
🔥🔥🔥...	Bring back YouTube DMs	15M	3.0	70%	8	3.94
🔥...	Polishing YT Shorts UI	20M	1.5	90%	3	9.0
🔥...	Convey Product Updates	18M	1.0	90%	2	8.10
🔥...	Interested/Not Interested	25M	1.2	80%	1	24

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Thanks!

Problem Framing and Prioritization: YouTube

By Arpit Sahay and

Shrihari Upadhyaya

Tech stack used:



Personal Interview

Click here for detailed transcript